



Personal Survival Techniques (PST)

60 Practice Questions and Answers for STCW Exams

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Practice Set 1

Q1. Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon (EPIRB) is considered as:

- A) Primary means of alerting device
- B) Secondary means of alerting device
- C) Both primary and secondary
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: B (Secondary means of alerting device)

Q2. How can a Search and Rescue Radar Transponder (SART) effective range be maximized?

- A) The SART should be placed in water immediately after activation
- B) The SART should be put on high power mode
- C) Mount the SART horizontally with respect to rescue vessel radar
- D) It should be as high as possible

Correct Answer: D (It should be as high as possible)

Q3. On a passenger ship, muster of passengers must be carried out:

- A) Within one week after boarding the person
- B) Within 24 hours of leaving the port
- C) Whenever the passengers are settled out
- D) Anytime by surprise as decided by the master

Correct Answer: B (Within 24 hours of leaving the port)

Q4. The Thermal Protective Aid (TPA) should permit the wearer to remove it in the water:

- A) Not more than two minutes
- B) Not more than five minutes
- C) Not more than 10 minutes
- D) Not more than 15 minutes

Correct Answer: A (Not more than two minutes)

Q5. Which channel is designated as the VHF follow-on Communication channel required in all portable survival craft equipment?



- A) Channel 06
- B) Channel 70
- C) Channel 13
- D) Channel 16

Correct Answer: D (Channel 16)

Q6. How many survival craft VHF walkie-talkies are required to be carried on cargo ships above 500 Gross Registered Tonnage (GRT)?

- A) Two numbers
- B) Three numbers
- C) Four numbers
- D) Five numbers

Correct Answer: B (Three numbers)

Q7. You are at sea in an inflatable life raft in high altitudes, the greatest danger is:

- A) Collapse of the raft due to cold temperatures
- B) Asphyxiation due to keeping the canopy closed
- C) Hypothermia caused by cold temperature
- D) Starvation

Correct Answer: C (Hypothermia caused by cold temperature)

Q8. Prior to lowering the lifeboat, the most important item to check is:

- A) Oars
- B) Sail
- C) Boat plug
- D) Life preservers

Correct Answer: C (Boat plug)

Q9. You are on a survival craft broadcasting a distress message. What information is essential for rescuers?

- A) Nature of distress
- B) Time of the day
- C) Your radio call sign
- D) Your position by latitude and longitude

Correct Answer: D (Your position by latitude and longitude)

Q10. What is the type of battery used for EPIRB and your SART?

- A) Lead acid battery
- B) Solar rechargeable cells
- C) Lithium non-rechargeable
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: C (Lithium non-rechargeable)



- A) Locating signals are transmitted by survival craft VHF transceivers
- B) Locating signals are transmitted by search and rescue radar transponders
- C) Locating signals are intended to facilitate the finding of distress vessel or survivors
- D) Locating signals are not transmitted by auto alarm generators

Correct Answer: A (Locating signals are transmitted by survival craft VHF transceivers)

Q12. The person aboard a vessel signaling by raising and lowering his or her outstretched arms to each side is indicating:

- A) Danger, stay away
- B) All is clear, it is safe to pass
- C) All is clear, it is safe to approach
- D) A distress signal

Correct Answer: D (A distress signal)

Q13. You are involved in an emergency landing of a helicopter in water. You should inflate your life jacket:

- A) Upon entering the helicopter
- B) Prior to reaching the water
- C) After reaching the water but prior to exiting the helicopter
- D) After clear of the helicopter

Correct Answer: D (After clear of the helicopter)

Q14. Choose the right combination of VHF channels for emergency communication during search and rescue for ship-to-ship and ship-to-aircraft communication:

- A) Channel 21 and 23
- B) Channel 06 and 30
- C) Channel 16 and 06
- D) Channel 70 and 16

Correct Answer: C (Channel 16 and 06)

Q15. Davit-launched life raft can be boarded:

- A) From the water only
- B) At the deck
- C) By jumping down onto it
- D) Through the escape tube

Correct Answer: B (At the deck)

Q16. Cargo ships of 100 meters and above but less than 150 meters should have how many life buoys?

- A) 8
- B) 12
- C) 30
- D) 14

Correct Answer: C (30)



- A) S-band radar
- B) Digital selective calling (DSC) receiver
- C) Satellite communication terminals
- D) X-band radar

Correct Answer: D (X-band radar)

Q18. With a sprinkler system and air system on and all hatches shut, the survival craft will provide protection from:

- A) Nuclear environment
- B) Fire and toxic environment
- C) Storm or a hurricane
- D) Sea creatures

Correct Answer: B (Fire and toxic environment)

Q19. What must be the characteristics of a lifebuoy attached with a self-igniting light and smoke?

- A) Two hours of light with two candle luminous intensity with 15 minutes of smoke
- B) One hour of light with 15 minutes of smoke
- C) Two hours of light with two hours of smoke
- D) 15 minutes of light with 15 minutes of smoke

Correct Answer: A (Two hours of light with two candle luminous intensity with 15 minutes of smoke)

Q20. The most important reason for taking anti-seasickness pills as soon as possible after entering into a life raft is to:

- A) Assist in sleeping
- B) Reduce appetite by decreasing nausea
- C) Prevent loss of body moisture by vomiting
- D) Prevent impact judgment due to motion-induced deliriousness

Correct Answer: C (Prevent loss of body moisture by vomiting)

Q21. The rescue vessel is approaching an activated SART at a distance of five miles. What indication appears on the rescue vessel radar screen?

- A) SOS symbol appears on the display of the radar screen
- B) Concentric circles
- C) A series of 12 equally spaced blips outward from the SART's position along its line of bearing
- D) Wide arcs

Correct Answer: C (A series of 12 equally spaced blips outward from the SART's position along its line of bearing)

Q22. On what frequency do EPIRBs transmit information to satellites on emergency activation?

- A) 121.5 MHz
- B) 243 MHz
- C) 156.8 MHz
- D) 406 MHz

Correct Answer: D (406 MHz)

Q23. What is the biggest danger to life when your vessel has collided with another ship?

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- A) Oil pollution
- B) Building of compartments
- C) Damage to the ship
- D) Possibility of capsizing

Correct Answer: D (Possibility of capsizing)

Q24. What should be the duration and luminous intensity of a hand flare?

- A) 60 seconds with 30,000 candles
- B) 60 seconds with 15,000 candles
- C) 120 seconds with 30,000 candles
- D) 120 seconds with 15,000 candles

Correct Answer: B (60 seconds with 15,000 candles)

Q25. One of the main characteristics of a life jacket is:

- A) To swim
- B) To maintain the face of an unconscious person above the water level
- C) To float
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: B (To maintain the face of an unconscious person above the water level)

Q26. Crew duties to passengers in an emergency especially in a passenger vessel involve:

- A) Warn all passengers
- B) Keeping the movement of the passengers towards the muster station
- C) Seeing that they have suitably donned the life jackets in a correct manner
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Q27. What indication does an EPIRB give on activation?

- A) Voice prompt saying EPIRB is activated
- B) Strobe lights or flashes on top of the EPIRB
- C) Gives out a printout of distress message sent
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: B (Strobe lights or flashes on top of the EPIRB)

Q28. How many buoyant orange smoke floats should be kept on the bridge of a vessel?

- A) Two
- B) Four
- C) Six
- D) None

Correct Answer: D (None)



- A) Whistle and light
- B) Reflective tape
- C) Whistle, reflective tape, and a light
- D) Only a whistle

Correct Answer: C (Whistle, reflective tape, and a light)

Q30. How do you know how many persons a lifeboat can accommodate?

- A) Ask your chief officer
- B) No limitations, you can put maximum persons inside
- C) Number of persons it can hold is clearly marked on the outside of the lifeboat
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: C (Number of persons it can hold is clearly marked on the outside of the lifeboat)

Practice Set 2

Q1. The number of lifebuoys on ship is dependent on:

- A) What owners provide
- B) Minimum of 10
- C) Minimum of 15
- D) Length of the vessel

Correct Answer: D (Length of the vessel)

Q2. EPIRB stands for:

- A) Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon
- B) Emergency Position Indicating Radar Beacon
- C) Escape Position Indicating Radar Beacon
- D) Escape Position Indicating Radio Beacon

Correct Answer: A (Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon)

Q3. Which of the following requirements for Immersion suit is correct?

- A) Donned within 2 minutes
- B) Allow the wearer to jump from 4.5m
- C) Allow the wearer to climb a vertical ladder of 5mtrs
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Q4. How much faster does the human body lose heat in the water?

- A) 10
- B) 20
- C) 26
- D) 36

Correct Answer: C (26)

Q5. When person floating in the water in group, they should be in:



- A) Help position
- B) Huddle position
- C) Yoga position
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: B (Huddle position)

Q6. How should the painter of a liferaft which is fitted with hydrostatic release unit be secured to the ship?

- A) Secured via weak link to a secured point on the ship
- B) Secured to the part of hydrostatic release that is designed to break free
- C) It should not be secured anyway
- D) Directly to a secure point on the ship

Correct Answer: A (Secured via weak link to a secured point on the ship)

Q7. LTA is used as:

- A) Messenger line
- B) Heaving line
- C) Mooring Line
- D) Lashing line

Correct Answer: A (Messenger line)

Q8. Life jacket light shall be capable of providing luminous intensity of _____ for a period of _____:

- A) .75cd/8hrs
- B) .50cd/8hrs
- C) .75cd/6hrs
- D) .50cd/6hrs

Correct Answer: A (.75cd/8hrs)

Q9. Lifeboat must be stowed in such a way that they can be launched in _____ mins:

- A) 10 mins
- B) 15 mins
- C) 20 mins
- D) 05 mins

Correct Answer: A (10 mins)

Q10. A distress signal on deck:

- A) Pyrotechnics
- B) Open fire
- C) NC Flag
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)



- A) Search and Rescue Radar Transponder
- B) Search and Rescue Radar Transformer
- C) Search and Rescue Radar Transmission
- D) Search and Rescue Radar Transmisor

Correct Answer: A (Search and Rescue Radar Transponder)

Q12. Your vessel has been in collision and you are not sure if your vessel is sinking or not, How will you handle this situation?

- A) Make sure that the lifeboat has as much fuel as possible and make your course for nearest land
- B) Wait and see how the situation is developing
- C) Search for missing person, continue to monitor the situation and prepare for event management in case it becomes necessary
- D) Leave the vessel and stay not closer than 5 NM

Correct Answer: C (Search for missing person, continue to monitor the situation and prepare for event management in case it becomes necessary)

Q13. What is a fire wire?

- A) Wire for pulling burning ships off the pier
- B) Wire for handling fire bucket
- C) Wire for pulling fire hoses upto the top bridge
- D) Wire for securing smoke divers

Correct Answer: A (Wire for pulling burning ships off the pier)

Q14. Quantity of water in lifeboat per person:

- A) 3Ltrs
- B) 5Ltrs
- C) 4Ltrs
- D) 2Ltrs

Correct Answer: A (3Ltrs)

Q15. How many servival craft walkie talkie required as per SOLAS for a ship of more than 500GT?

- A) 2
- B) 3
- C) 5
- D) 1

Correct Answer: A (2)

Q16. Quantity of water in Life raft per person:

- A) 1.5 Ltrs
- B) 2 Ltrs
- C) 3 Ltrs
- D) 2.5 Ltrs

Correct Answer: A (1.5 Ltrs)



- A) The floor of the raft has a second layer which can be inflated to give additional insulation from the cold
- B) The floor of the raft has a second layer which can be inflated to help insulation in addition to the TPA
- C) TPA for each person
- D) At least 10% or 2 TPA of the total crew

Correct Answer: B (The floor of the raft has a second layer which can be inflated to help insulation in addition to the TPA)

Q18. Which of the listed requirements do not corresponds to present regulation the life raft shall have:

- A) Manually controlled lamp visible of at least two miles fitted at the top of the canopy
- B) All entrances fitted with rigid boarding ramps for boarding the life raft
- C) Floor preventing the ingress of water
- D) Manually controlled lamp fitted inside the liferaft

Correct Answer: B (All entrances fitted with rigid boarding ramps for boarding the life raft)

Q19. In free fall Lifeboat, instead of Immersion suit TPA is provided for all persons:

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: B (False)

Q20. Your vessel have been in collision with another vessel, you are taking in water and you have to prepare for leaving the vessel. How will you act?

- A) Just jump overboard and be ready
- B) Collect your own personal belongings
- C) Assist your friends to collect their personal belonging
- D) Send a distress message and collect survival suits/Thermal bags

Correct Answer: D (Send a distress message and collect survival suits/Thermal bags)

Q21. Which one of the listed requirements regarding the stowage of a survival craft corresponds to present SOLAS regulations? Each survival craft shall be stowed:

- A) Wherever space is available
- B) In a state of readiness so that two crew members can prepare
- C) On the starboard side of the ship
- D) In a secure and sheltered position and protected from damage by fire and explosion

Correct Answer: B (In a state of readiness so that two crew members can prepare)

Q22. Which one of the listed requirements regarding LSA do not corresponds to present regulations?

- A) All prescribed LSA shall be made of non-combustible or fire retardant material
- B) All prescribed LSA shall be of a highly visible colour
- C) All prescribed LSA shall be fitted with a retro reflective material which will assist in detection
- D) All prescribed LSA shall be resistant to deterioration where exposed to sunlight

Correct Answer: A (All prescribed LSA shall be made of non-combustible or fire retardant material)

Q23. Which one of the listed requirements regarding launching appliances for survival craft and rescue boats not corresponds to present regulation?



- A) Parts requiring regular maintenance by ships crew shall be readily accessible
- B) The launching mechanism shall be arranged for actuating from a position within the survival craft or rescue boat in addition to a position on the ships deck
- C) All launching appliances shall be capable of recovering survival craft and rescue boats with their crew
- D) Launching appliances shall be constructed for minimum amount of routine maintainance

Correct Answer: C (All launching appliances shall be capable of recovering survival craft and rescue boats with their crew)

Q24. Maximum carrying capacity of a lifeboat:

- A) 100 Persons
- B) 150 Persons
- C) 50 Persons
- D) 25 Persons

Correct Answer: B (150 Persons)

Q25. An Immersion suit shall permit the person wearing it:

- A) Climb up and down a vertical ladder of atleast 5m in length
- B) Perform normal duties associated with abandoning ship
- C) Jump from a height of not less than 4.5m
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Q26. Checking and servicing life rafts as per PMS is:

- A) Once a year
- B) Twice a year
- C) Once in 5 years
- D) Based on condition of Liferaft

Correct Answer: A (Once a year)

Q27. Before lifting a Lifeboat from water it should be ensured that:

- A) Bottom plug is secured tight
- B) Falls wires are clear and secured tightly
- C) Engine is going astern
- D) Sea anchor is streamed

Correct Answer: B (Falls wires are clear and secured tightly)

Q28. Which one of the routine test and inspection of LSA is not required by regulations:

- A) Lifeboat engine should be run for atleast 3 mins every week
- B) General emergency alarm to be tested daily
- C) Survival craft and Rescue boats with launching appliances shall be visually inspected weekly
- D) Inspection of Lifeboat equipments shall be carried out monthly

Correct Answer: B (General emergency alarm to be tested daily)



- A) Substitute for limit switch of gravity davits
- B) To automatically unhook the lashing and release the life raft when the ship sinks
- C) For releasing life raft in bad weather
- D) For releasing lifeboat from sinking vessel

Correct Answer: B (To automatically unhook the lashing and release the life raft when the ship sinks)

Q30. Lifeboat should have:

- A) 2 Buoyant rescue quoits, attached to not less than 30mtrs buoyant line
- B) 2 buoyant rescue quoits attached to not less than 15mtrs buoyant line
- C) 1 Buoyant rescue quoits, attached to not less than 30mtrs buoyant line
- D) 1 buoyant rescue quoits attached to not less than 15mtrs buoyant line

Correct Answer: A (2 Buoyant rescue quoits, attached to not less than 30mtrs buoyant line)